



Document Design Capstone: Professional Identity and Usability Analysis Prepared by: Stephanie R. Wilder

Professional Persona: Ops Architect | Technical Operations Specialist

Date: March 18, 2026

Digital Hub: www.maswildlabs.com

github.com/maswildlabs

linkedin.com/in/stephanierwilder

Portfolio Contents:

Brand Identity Analysis: A comparative study of Spectrio and Mood Media's market strategies and visual communication

Applying CRAP Principles: A redesign evaluation of a 2021 California Labor Law Poster using Contrast, Repetition, Alignment, and Proximity.

Professional Identity & Rationale: The "Mas Wild Labs" brand development, including the Ops Architect resume and project rationale.

Usability Evaluation: Technical Documentation Critique and proposed redesign of a minimalist hardware installation guide to improve "real-world" user experience.

Reflective Essay: The Evolution of Design - A synthesis of how brand identity, design principles, and technical writing intersect in professional practice.



Module 1: Brand Identity Analysis

In today's market, a brand is defined by the environment it creates, not just the products it sells. From a technical support perspective, Spectrio's operational model appears to balance advanced technology with a focus on human emotions. While Spectrio's main competitor, Mood Media, also focuses on "sight, sound, and scent," they take two very different paths: Spectrio acts as an active creative partner, while Mood Media brands themselves as a global authority.

The "Digital Glow" vs. "High-Impact Variety"

Spectrio's branding is a statement of intent. According to their Brand Guidelines, they use a vibrant palette of Deep Purple (44218D) and Teal (90FCF9) to represent the "digital glow" of the screens they manage. This signals that they are a high-energy, tech-forward company. By using Graphik Bold and Roboto fonts, they make complex digital signage feel as simple as using a smartphone app.

In contrast, Mood Media uses a high-impact, busy look. Their digital presence is filled with dense menus and a massive list of industries and services. While Spectrio focuses on a clean, modern aesthetic, Mood Media highlights its global reach and variety. They position themselves as a "one-stop shop" for everything from local cafes to global retail chains, even if it makes their branding feel more crowded.

Despite their distinct visual styles, both organizations share foundational industry standards that align their market presence. A primary similarity is found in their target demographics, as both brands prioritize the healthcare and retail sectors by tailoring messaging to address specific engagement challenges. Furthermore, both firms treat brand identity as the primary interface for communicating technical and professional capabilities to potential clients. Finally, each company builds its core value proposition around a shared sensory focus, utilizing a trifecta of "sight, sound, and scent" to influence consumer behavior.

Roadmaps vs. Detailed Networks



Spectrio prioritizes simplicity. They use strict rules for "breathing room" around their logo to keep messaging clean and uncluttered. This structural clarity helps busy clients—like healthcare providers and retailers—solve problems without feeling overwhelmed. They provide a roadmap for engagement.

Mood Media takes a more complex approach as a broad-scale integrator. Their structure is dense and detailed, aimed at proving they have a solution for every possible niche. They provide a detailed network of options, appealing to large corporations that need deep, specialized services across hundreds of global locations.

Partner vs. Authority

Spectrio's identity is built on the concept of being a Creative Partner. Their look tells the customer, "We are in this with you". They aren't just vendors; they're an extension of the customer's marketing team. This is perfect for mid-market businesses that need a fresh, "done-for-you" solution.

Mood Media, conversely, leans into its identity as a Global Authority. By showcasing massive scale and a complex network of options, they appeal to the need for a vendor with a proven, worldwide infrastructure. While Spectrio emphasizes the energy of business growth, Mood Media emphasizes the security of established global dominance.

Spectrio's identity serves as a foundational component of its market strategy, focusing on the core pillars of vibrancy, clarity, and partnership. While Spectrio utilizes high-contrast digital aesthetics to signal a modern, collaborative approach, its competitors like Mood Media leverage scale and complexity to establish themselves as global authorities. Ultimately, both organizations demonstrate that in a technology-driven market, brand identity functions as the primary interface through which professional capabilities are communicated.



Module 2: Applying CRAP Principles

This analysis evaluates a 2021 California Labor Law Poster used for workplace compliance. Its purpose is to inform employees of their legal rights regarding wages, safety, and discrimination, though its current design significantly hinders its effectiveness.

Contrast

The current arrangement of text makes it difficult for employees to scan specific sections. Beyond the bold yellow "California 2021" banner and the blue OSHA panel, which provide some initial distinction, the document quickly regresses into a dense "wall" of small-print black text on a white background. While there are occasional splashes of color in headers, the density of the document prevents these elements from creating a functional visual hierarchy. Furthermore, the over-reliance on the generic phrase "Employee Rights" across multiple section headers fails to provide the necessary contrast required to distinguish between different legal protections.

Repetition

The poster lacks a unified design system, functioning more as a collection of disparate documents than a cohesive guide. A primary failure in repetition is the inconsistent treatment of minimum wage information. The Federal section utilizes a prominent red header, whereas the California section—which often features a higher, more relevant wage—uses a plain black header that recedes into the background. While the poster attempts to repeat a modular box format, the inconsistent use of graphic icons versus text-only blocks creates a disjointed aesthetic. Without consistently repeating fonts, colors, and styles, the document loses professional authority and becomes difficult to navigate.

Alignment

Although the poster utilizes a basic modular layout, it lacks a disciplined grid system, resulting in a "message board" appearance where notices seem taped together haphazardly. There is no consistent horizontal or vertical axis for the eye to follow. Internal alignment is equally erratic; text blocks shift between left-aligned, centered, and justified formats without a clear structural rationale. This



lack of a cohesive alignment strategy generates visual clutter and undermines the document's professional credibility.

Proximity

Logical grouping is noticeably absent in the current layout. Related topics are scattered across the canvas; for instance, "Paid Sick Leave" and "Payday Notices" are positioned in the bottom corners, separated from the primary "Employee Rights" section at the top left. This fragmentation forces the reader to hunt for related information. Additionally, the "Emergency" and "Job Safety" sections lack adequate white space, with text extending to the very edge of the borders. This lack of "breathing room" creates a claustrophobic effect that may discourage employees from engaging with the material, ultimately leaving them uninformed about their rights.

Recommendations

- **Standardize Headers (Repetition):** Implement a uniform font, size, and color for every major law header to establish the poster as a single, cohesive document.
- **Use Color Coding (Contrast):** Apply distinct color palettes to categorize information, such as using one color for Federal mandates and another for State laws to improve scannability.
- **Enforce a Strict Grid (Alignment):** Rebuild the layout on a formal three-column grid where headers align horizontally across the page to eliminate the current chaotic appearance.
- **Group by Subject (Proximity):** Consolidate related notices—specifically wage and hour information—into a single visual area with increased white space to reduce the sense of overcrowding.



Module 3: Branding - Business Card

STEPHANIE R. WILDER

OPS ARCHITECT



MAS WILD LABS

[GITHUB.COM/MASWILDLABS](https://github.com/maswildlabs)

SYSTEM_SERVICES

- [X] OPERATIONAL ARCHITECTURE
- [X] LOGIC VALIDATION
- [X] HIGH-TIER DOCUMENTATION
- [X] SYSTEM INTEGRITY

CONTACT:

MASWILDLABS@GMAIL.COM

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Stephanie R. Wilder

Ops Architect | Technical Operations Specialist | Fresno, CA 93726 | 559-304-9111

Digital Hub: github.com/maswildlabs | linkedin.com/in/stephanierwilder

Contact: maswildlabs@gmail.com

Professional Summary

Technical Operations Leader with 15 years of IT systems experience specializing in Operational Support Design. Proven track record of architecting end-to-end technical workflows and escalation paths for national product rollouts. Expert at translating complex system requirements into scalable training curricula and standard operating procedures (SOPs) that bridge the gap between development and Tier 1 support.

Core Competencies

Operational Architecture: SME Partnership, Support Tier Structuring, Pilot Program Leadership, Process Mapping.

Logic Validation: Tier 2 Troubleshooting, RMM Dashboards, ConnectWise, Digital Signage, Network Security.

High-Tier Documentation: Knowledge Base (KB) Creation, Technical Writing, Training Validation, SOP Development.

System Integrity: Team Mentorship, Active Listening, Problem-Solving, Infrastructure Stability.



Professional Experience

Spectrio | Remote

Lead Ops Architect - National Product Launch | June 2022 - Present

Operational Architecture & Pilot Leadership: Hand-selected as one of two lead technicians to spearhead the high-stakes Kia dealership Kiosk pilot, establishing the technical foundation for a national rollout.

Logic Validation & Workflow Engineering: Collaboratively engineered the primary operational frameworks and technical SOPs for company-wide implementation.

Service Model Design: Partnered with Learning & Development (L&D) to design a tiered service model, defining critical escalation paths to optimize ticket routing and efficiency.

High-Tier Documentation & Knowledge Management: Authored and audited the foundational technical guides and internal Knowledge Base (KB) articles that serve as the organization's primary training curriculum.

System Integrity & Readiness: Facilitated advanced troubleshooting and software training for team members to ensure department-wide readiness for new hardware deployments.

Performance Management: Managed system performance and stability for enterprise-level digital signage portfolios.

Metro Networks LLC | Fresno, CA

IT Help Desk / MSP Specialist | June 2021 - Nov 2021

High-Volume System Management: Acted as the first point of contact in a fast-paced MSP environment, providing rapid diagnosis for diverse technical issues via phone and email.

System Remediation: Executed NOC-driven remediations via RMM dashboards and managed complex ticket lifecycles within ConnectWise to maintain system stability.

Network Integrity & Troubleshooting: Diagnosed and resolved intricate hardware and network connectivity issues for PCs and interconnected systems.



Education & Professional Development

Kansas State University Salina | Online | In Progress

Professional Coursework: Technical Writing

Applying advanced documentation principles to the creation of Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and Knowledge Base (KB) architecture.

Fresno City College | Fresno, CA

Certificate of Achievement, Cybersecurity | 2021 - 2022

Heald College | Fresno, CA

Associate of Applied Science, Network Security and Administration

Honors Graduate; Student Mentor for the Information Technology Program.



The Rationale Behind Mas Wild Labs

This rationale details the technical and style decisions I made to align my professional identity with the standards of the technology and technical writing industries. My goal was to transition my brand into an Ops Architect persona role focused on the design and validation of operational systems. The following sections explain how the Mas Wild Labs identity bridges the gap between technical complexity and user-facing documentation.

The business name "Mas Wild Labs" is an intentional choice rooted in my identity within the roller derby community, where I have served as a Non-Skating Official (NSO) for 13 seasons.

By carrying my nickname, into my business name, I am leveraging my experience in officiating roller derby—a role that requires extreme precision, rule enforcement, and logic.

Integrating this personal history shows high accountability and a unique, "tech-noir" perspective on problem-solving that sets my brand apart from generic corporate identities.

Integrating this personal history shows high accountability and a unique, 'tech-noir' perspective on problem-solving that sets my brand apart from generic corporate identities. The black/green terminal palette and circuit-pen hybrid logo were chosen to evoke the 'tech-noir' precision of roller-derby rule enforcement and enterprise monitoring dashboards. I chose the title Ops Architect to reflect a career shift toward high-level workflow design

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My role in piloting Kia's national kiosk program served as the catalyst for this identity shift. By engineering the primary technical frameworks and SOPs for the rollout, I redefined my professional scope from standard support to structural systems engineering



I adopted a "checklist" aesthetic using square brackets `[X]` for core competencies to mirror a system status report, signaling that my work is rooted in "proven logic" - a direct callback to my business tagline.

To me, Mas Wild Labs represents my commitment to the "proven logic" and "system integrity" that have defined my roles as both a technical leader and a dedicated roller derby official. Ultimately, I hope the design choices detailed in this rationale demonstrate a readiness to meet the rigorous demands of technical writing and operations...and isn't "too" casual.



Module 4: Usability Evaluation: Technical Documentation

Evaluation of the Ubiquiti Cloud Gateway Ultra Installation Guide

My favorite brand of networking technology is the Ubiquiti line of products. I find that they are intuitive and simple to set up together, and they also provide visibility all in one interface that some products do not. For this assignment, I chose the Ubiquiti Cloud Gateway Ultra Installation Guide. It is a very minimalist guide, which I am not a fan of. I do have technical knowledge, but sometimes staring at a manual with a bunch of pictures and no written information can be intimidating for those who might not have very strong technical skills.

The landscape of technology has changed; we no longer must build Ethernet cables by hand, and even a home user can set up a switch. This document is great for a knowledgeable tech enthusiast but lacks information that might help the layperson understand what they are doing.

Analysis of Design Weaknesses

Clarity

The biggest issue with this document is that it relies almost entirely on pictures and has basically no text. While I understand this helps avoid the need for translations, it makes things confusing. For example, on page 2, the "Package Contents" use labels "a" through "d," but there is no key to telling you what those parts are. Someone who isn't tech-savvy might not know if item "c" is a standard Cat5e or a faster Cat6 cable, or if the power adapter has specific requirements they need to watch out for. Without words, you're basically left guessing about the hardware you're holding.

Consistency



The labeling throughout the guide feels random. Page 2 sets up a list of four items (a, b, c, d), but the next few pages don't really stick to that plan. On page 4, the guide points to ports "a" and "c," but never mentions what happened to "b" or "d." This forces you to flip back and forth to figure out which part goes where, which is frustrating and makes a "simple" setup feel much more complicated than it needs to be.

Organization

There is a major "missing link" in how the steps are organized. The guide tells you to download the app in Step 3 and then jumps straight to finishing the setup in Step 4. It doesn't explain how to get from the software to the hardware. It leaves out important details, like whether the device needs to be fully powered on before you open the app, or how close you need to be for Bluetooth to connect. By just showing a picture of a phone with an arrow, the guide assumes everyone already understands how wireless syncing works.

Usability

From a practical standpoint, this guide is useless if anything goes wrong because there is zero troubleshooting help. It only shows the "perfect" scenario. In Step 1, it shows you how to plug in the power, but if the light on the device doesn't turn on, the manual doesn't tell you what to do next. While there is a tiny mention of a Help Center at the very end, not having basic "if/then" tips on the page makes it a lot less helpful for real-world situations where things rarely go perfectly.

Proposed Redesign and Improvements

To fix these issues, the "Package Contents" section should be turned into an actual list with names and descriptions. Instead of just "Component A" or "B," the guide should clearly state that you are looking at the Cloud Gateway Ultra and a USB-C Power Supply.



Figure 1: Proposed Redesign of Package Contents

Item	Component Name	Description
A	Cloud Gateway Ultra	The primary security gateway and UniFi controller.
B	USB-C Power Supply	Requirement: 5V DC, 3A. Use only the provided adapter
C	Ethernet Cable	Category 6 (Cat6) patch cable for modem connection.
D	Mounting Hardware	Screws and anchors for wall-mounting.

Including the actual specs—like the 5V power requirement—provides a safety check that a drawing of a plug just can't communicate.

I would also add a "Pre-Configuration" checklist before the app step. This would tell the user to make sure their Bluetooth is on and to wait for a specific light pattern on the Gateway before they even open the UniFi app.

- ✓ **Power-On Verification:** Plug in the USB-C adapter and wait for the "Ready for Setup" prompt on the device screen.
- ✓ **Bluetooth Connectivity:** Ensure your mobile device has Bluetooth enabled and is within 5 feet of the gateway.
- ✓ **Status Light:** Do not open the UniFi app until the gateway displays a steady light pattern.

Adding a small "Troubleshooting" box to explain what to do if the power light doesn't come on would turn this from a simple flyer into a real, functional tool.

- If the device does not power on: Check that the USB-C cable is fully seated in both the gateway and the outlet.
- If the app cannot find the gateway: Restart your phone's Bluetooth and ensure no other heavy wireless interference is nearby.

These small changes would give a regular person the context they need to set up their network without feeling like they're in over their heads.



Overall Verdict

Overall, this is a decent Quick Start Guide for a tech expert who just wants to get things running in 60 seconds. However, it's a pretty poor manual for a beginner because it assumes you already know what you're doing and that your internet and app will work perfectly.

In my own experience, I've found that manufacturer manuals are often so obsessed with being "minimalist" that they forget to give you the real-world help you need. I usually end up looking at third-party websites or forums to get my answers because they provide the practical, written details that Ubiquiti leaves out. The hardware is great, but the documentation would be much better if it acknowledged that not everyone is a pro and that a few clear sentences can be worth more than a dozen icons.



Reflective Essay: The Evolution of Design and Brand Identity

The process of evaluating technical documentation has served as an exercise in shifting my perspective from a passive consumer of technology to a critical designer of technical information. This evolution in understanding brand identity and design principles has highlighted the delicate balance between aesthetic minimalism and functional utility.

The Evolution of Brand Identity

To be honest, branding wasn't something I really thought about when it came to technical writing; I viewed it more as a marketing "vibe" than a functional requirement. My understanding has since transitioned from seeing brand identity as just an aesthetic choice to recognizing it as a functional promise made to the user. Previously, I might have viewed a sleek, minimalist approach as the hallmark of modern, intuitive design. However, analyzing poor documentation revealed that a brand identity focused solely on "simplicity" can alienate its audience if it sacrifices clarity for aesthetics. I now recognize that for a technical brand to be successful, it must bake reliability and accessibility into its DNA; if the documentation fails to support a user when things go wrong, the brand's promise of an "intuitive" experience is effectively broken. This realization has shifted my focus toward ensuring that my work doesn't just look the part, but follows through on the professional capabilities the brand claims to represent.

Applying CRAP Principles in Evaluation

Applying the CRAP (Contrast, Repetition, Alignment, Proximity) principles has provided a structured language for what I previously only felt as frustration with a manual.



Contrast: I learned that contrast isn't just about colors, but about making critical information—like specific power requirements—stand out from general setup steps to ensure safety.

Repetition: My evaluation of the guide's labeling (using "a" through "d") showed that inconsistent repetition creates a "mental tax" for the user, forcing them to flip back and forth to identify parts that should have been consistently labeled throughout the document.

Alignment: I am now looking for a disciplined grid system to avoid a "message board" appearance where notices seem haphazard. Lack of cohesive alignment strategy generates visual clutter and undermines professional credibility.

Proximity: I now look for the relationship between software instructions and hardware state. The "missing link" in the original guide—placing an app download step immediately after a hardware plugin without a status check—violates the principle of proximity by separating related physical and digital actions.

Communicating Personal Brand and Usability

Analyzing poor design has sharpened my eye for usability by forcing me to adopt the "persona" of a layperson. I realized that my own technical knowledge can sometimes be a blind spot. To communicate my personal brand as an Ops Architect, I must prioritize the user's "real-world" experience over a manufacturer's desire for a "clean" look. This means incorporating "if/then" troubleshooting logic and clear, descriptive tables that provide a safety net for the user. My brand, Mas Wild Labs, leverages my background in officiating—a role requiring extreme precision and logic—to bridge the gap between technical complexity and user-facing documentation.

Future Applications

These skills are directly transferable to my academic and professional goals in technical writing.

Academic: In my coursework, I can now move beyond "good-looking" assignments to those that are functionally superior through better information architecture.



Professional: As a specialist, I can advocate for philosophies that emphasize technical accuracy and spec-heavy documentation over vague icons.

Creative: In my own projects, I will ensure that my documentation empowers the user to solve their own problems, building a brand identity rooted in "proven logic" and system integrity.

Conclusion

Ultimately, the shift from analyzing corporate branding to deconstructing poor technical design has redefined my approach to technical communication. By applying the CRAP principles to real-world examples, I have moved beyond a surface-level appreciation for "clean" aesthetics toward a deeper commitment to functional clarity and user empowerment. I have learned that a truly effective brand identity—whether for a global corporation or a personal venture must function as a reliable interface that bridges the gap between complex systems and the people who use them.

As I move forward in my career, I will carry these lessons into my future writing. Whether I am engineering national product rollouts or drafting internal SOPs, my focus will remain on "proven logic" and system integrity. By prioritizing the user's need for context and troubleshooting over the manufacturer's desire for minimalism, I can ensure that my documentation doesn't just look professional but works in the real world.

And while I've worked hard to ensure this analysis meets the rigorous standards of the course, I'll consider it a success if my brand remains exactly 10% too casual for traditional tech writing—after all, a little "tech-noir" personality is what keeps the logic human